



PRD Review

Week 3 • Day 5 • Mini-Capstone Ships Today

TPM Academy



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- Pass a **secondary review** conducted by a different reviewer
- Ship the **mini-capstone deliverable**: signed-off PRD + review trail



Today's Cadence (different)

Clock	Block
09:00 – 09:15	Opening; pairings posted
09:15 – 10:45	Primary review round 1
10:45 – 11:00	Break
11:00 – 12:00	Author response + clarifying conversation
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch
13:00 – 14:30	Revisions
14:30 – 14:45	Break
14:45 – 15:45	Secondary review
15:45 – 16:00	Wrap + sign-off



The Pairing Structure

Each PRD is read by **two** primary reviewers in the morning, then by a **different** secondary reviewer in the afternoon.

PRD authors	AM primary reviewers	PM secondary
A	B, C	D
B	C, D	E
C	D, E	F
D	E, F	A

Each triad has 3 reading roles today: primary $\times 2$ in AM, secondary $\times 1$ in PM.
Plus owning your own PRD throughout.

Block 1 — The Friday Rubric

What "exemplary" looks like, dimension by dimension



The Rubric (0–4 per dimension)

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary (4)
Problem clarity	20%	Engineer could scope without clarifying call
AC testability	25%	Each AC implementable + falsifiable; covers happy/sad/weird
NFR completeness	20%	5 categories present; each has a defended target
Strategy linkage	15%	Goals tie to Week-2 NS / KPIs / journey friction
Risk honesty	10%	Real risks named; "no risks" is fail
Writing discipline	10%	Clear, specific; no AI-generic prose

Score thresholds: ≥ 3.0 ships as-is. 2.0–2.9 ships with named gaps. $< 2.0 \rightarrow$ facilitator intervenes.

What Good Reviewing Looks Like

Bad review

- "§2 is unclear"
- "AC could be more specific"
- "NFRs feel light"
- No section citations
- Praise is generic

Good review

- "§2 doesn't say small-shop or large-shop dispatchers; that changes scope"
- "AC #4: 'system handles errors gracefully' — propose: 'Given timeout >5s, when user retries, then queued for offline submit'"
- "NFR-7 has no Compliance entry; SOC 2 audit-trail missing"
- Every finding cites a section
- Praise is specific

The rule: if you say "could be more specific", you write the specific version.



The Review Document

```
# Review of PRD: <feature name="">
**Reviewers:** <reviewer triad="">
**PRD authors:** <author triad="">

<h2 id="scores-04-per-dimension">Scores (0–4 per dimension)</h2>
<p>| Dimension | Score | One-line rationale |
| ... |</p>
<p><strong>Total:</strong> [weighted sum, out of 4.0]</p>
<h2 id="top-3-strengths-specific">Top 3 strengths (specific)</h2>
<ol>
<li>...</li>
</ol>
<h2 id="top-5-specific-findings">Top 5 specific findings</h2>
<ol>
<li>$ ____ - <label></label></li>
</ol>
<ul>
<li>What we observed:</li>
<li>Why it matters:</li>
<li>Suggested fix:</li>
</ul>
</author></reviewer></feature>
```

Open questions for the author triad

Three strengths is required. Honest praise builds the trust that lets the harder feedback land.

Activity 1 — Primary Review (AM)

Two reviewing triads per PRD • 90 minutes

- 0–10 min: read §§1–5; score Problem clarity + Strategy linkage
- 10–35 min: read §§6–7; score AC + NFRs
- 35–55 min: read §§8–11; score Risk honesty
- 55–75 min: write review document
- 75–90 min: refine + submit (no coordination with the other reviewer triad)



10 + 25 + 20 + 20 + 15

Block 2 — Author Response + Clarifying Conversation

In person; not about scores; about understanding

The Conversation

Not about negotiating scores. About clarifying findings and surfacing implicit feedback that didn't make the written review.

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2. **20 min:** author triad asks — "Walk us through finding #3"; "Which AC was worst?"

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The Conversation

1. **5 min:** each reviewing triad gives a 2-min spoken summary
2. **20 min:** author triad asks — "Walk us through finding #3"; "Which AC was worst?"
3. **25 min:** reviewers ask — "We assumed X; right?"; "We disagreed about Y; what's your take?"

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The Conversation

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2. **20 min:** author triad asks — "Walk us through finding #3"; "Which AC was worst?"
3. **25 min:** reviewers ask — "We assumed X; right?"; "We disagreed about Y; what's your take?"
4. **10 min:** author triad **summarizes what they heard** — adopt / defer / push back

Not about negotiating scores. About clarifying findings and surfacing implicit feedback that didn't make the written review.



Common Conversation Pitfalls

Pitfall	What to do
Author gets defensive	"What's the version of this finding you would accept?"
Reviewer softens at the table	"What did you write? Stand by it or revise."
Drift to debating the *idea*	"Today is the *PRD*. Critique the document, not the feature."
Authors skip the summary	Force it: "Tell us what you heard, in 60 seconds."

Activity 2 — Author Response Conversation

Triad-of-three (author + 2 reviewing triads) • 60 minutes

- 5 min: reviewer summaries
- 20 min: author triad asks
- 25 min: reviewers ask
- 10 min: author triad summarizes what they heard



5 + 20 + 25 + 10

Block 3 — Revisions

Adopt / Defer / Push back — with reasoning

The Three-Bucket Approach

Adopt

Change the PRD.
Note in resolution
log *what* you
changed.

Defer

Track elsewhere
(issue / ticket /
follow-up). Note
where in the log.

Push back

Decline the change.
Note *why* in the log.
The most senior
signal.

The trust signal: Push-back entries with reasoning. Show the triad thought, not just complied.



Worked Resolution Log

```
## Friday review-resolution log
```

```
<p><strong>Reviewers (AM):</strong> Triad B, Triad C
<strong>Total scores:</strong> B = 3.1 / C = 2.8 → addressed below</p>
<h3 id="adopted">Adopted</h3>
<ul>
<li>B/Finding 2: §6 AC #4 was untestable. Rewrote with explicit observable.</li>
<li>C/Finding 1: §7 missing Compliance NFR. Added retention + audit-trail.</li>
<li>B/Finding 5: §9 risk "tech adoption" had no mitigation. Added toggle.</li>
</ul>
<h3 id="deferred">Deferred</h3>
<ul>
<li>C/Finding 3: Multi-shop manager view. DEFERRED to §11 + ticket.</li>
</ul>
<h3 id="pushed-back">Pushed back</h3>
```

- B/Finding 4: Reviewer suggested splitting AC #2; declined because the "ands" describe one observable state. Reasoning preserved here.

Activity 3 — Revisions

Triads • 90 minutes

Sort findings; revise in priority order (coherence, then specificity, then prose); update the resolution log.

- 15 min: sort findings into Adopt / Defer / Push back
- 60 min: revise in priority order
- 15 min: update resolution log + flip status to "Revised — secondary pending"



15 + 60 + 15

Block 4 — Secondary Review + Sign-off

Different reviewer; revised PRD only; final score



The Secondary Reviewer's Job

The secondary reviewer does not relitigate AM findings. They evaluate the revised document on its own merits.



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1. Read the **revised** PRD + the **resolution log**
2. Did the resolution log line up with the actual changes? (*Honesty check*)

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1. Read the **revised** PRD + the **resolution log**
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3. Did revisions introduce new problems?

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1. Read the **revised** PRD + the **resolution log**
2. Did the resolution log line up with the actual changes? (*Honesty check*)
3. Did revisions introduce new problems?
4. Are deferrals reasonable?

The secondary reviewer does not relitigate AM findings. They evaluate the revised document on its own merits.



The Secondary Reviewer's Job

1. Read the **revised** PRD + the **resolution log**
2. Did the resolution log line up with the actual changes? (*Honesty check*)
3. Did revisions introduce new problems?
4. Are deferrals reasonable?
5. Score with the rubric — final number

The secondary reviewer does not relitigate AM findings. They evaluate the revised document on its own merits.



Verdict + Sign-Off

Score ≥ 3.0

Ships as-is. Status:
Approved.

Score 2.0–2.9

Ships with named
gaps captured in
resolution log.

Status: **Approved
with gaps.**

Score < 2.0

Needs further
revision. Facilitator
review.

Activity 4 — Secondary Review

Single reviewing triad • 60 minutes

- 35 min: read revised PRD + resolution log; score
- 15 min: write Secondary Review Note (improved / still needs work / verdict)
- 10 min: deliver to authors + sign-off



35 + 15 + 10



Week 3 Wrap

What we shipped

- 11-section technical PRD per triad
- 2 primary reviews per PRD
- Author response conversation
- Secondary review + sign-off
- Mini-capstone delivered

What opens Week 4

- **Technical Architecture & Constraints**
- Monolith vs microservices
- Security & compliance — revisited at architecture level
- System mapping; latency / availability targets
- AI restored; PRD becomes architecture input

Bring to Monday: your final PRD. The NFRs you wrote this week are the first draft of Week-4 architectural constraints.

Questions & Reflection

What's the one finding from your review that will change how you write the next PRD?